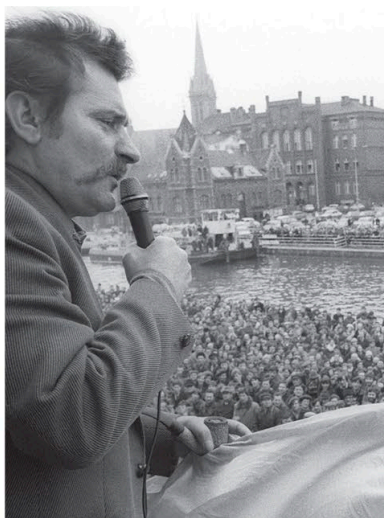


31 August 1980 POLAND'S SOLIDARITY TRADE UNION FOUNDED

Emerging from the Lenin Shipyards in Gdańsk, Solidarity became the focus for agitation for improved workers' rights and opposition to the country's Soviet-backed government. Within a year it had won the support of a third of the nation's working population. Despite attempts to close it down, including the imposition of martial law, it survived to play a decisive part in the ending of Communist rule.

▷ **Lech Wałęsa**, Solidarity's co-founder, addresses a crowd



1980 CHINA INTRODUCES THE ONE-CHILD POLICY

Faced with a rising population, China had – from 1970 on – introduced a recommended maximum of two children per family. Now most parents were restricted to a single child, and the policy was enforced through cash inducements for those who complied and heavy fines for offenders. In practice the population continued to grow, though at a reduced rate.



▽ Poster promoting the policy

4 November 1980
**Ronald Reagan is
elected** 40th
US president

1980

19 April 1980 **Robert
Mugabe** becomes the first
prime minister of an
independent Zimbabwe

“Practise birth control
for the revolution.”

*SLOGAN TO PROMOTE THE ONE-CHILD
POLICY IN CHINA, 1980*

22 September 1980 THE IRAN–IRAQ WAR BREAKS OUT

Seeking to establish supremacy in the oil-rich Persian Gulf region, Iraqi leader Saddam Hussein sent troops into neighbouring Iran, still shaken by the 1979 Islamic revolution. The invasion stalled after three months, following which the conflict bogged down into eight years of lethal stalemate that left more than half a million soldiers and civilians dead.



▽ Iraqi soldiers celebrate a victory